

Generative AI: Using It at Work

This article will help you to understand:

- what generative AI bots are
- what opportunities they bring
- the risks you need to be aware of
- what you should do about it
- what the organisation is doing about it
- terms relating to AI

Many people are currently talking about Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools and bots, such as Chat GPT, BingAI and Google Bard. This technology holds the potential to change the way we work, and comes with a multitude of opportunities and benefits but also some risks and considerations.

We want to enable the use of these tools to make citizens' lives better, but we need to ensure we do that in an ethical, secure, and considered way.

What are generative AI Bots?

ChatGPT, BingAI, DALL-E and Google Bard are examples of AI bots that you may already be aware of. These bots can respond to typed questions and commands ('prompts') in a way that seems human. They generate a response, usually text or an image, that you can then be used. These bots work by comparing your 'prompts' with a huge amount of online data. This allows the bot to:

- attempt to give the user the information they have asked for
- present information in a way that seems like you are talking to a human
- or in the case of image AI bots, provide generated images

What opportunities do they bring?

Examples of things that bots could be useful for are:

- summarising long pieces of content such as news articles
- drafting a letter or email template
- writing basic code or providing solutions to code errors
- providing interview questions based on a job description
- creating a logo or photo in the style of a historical artist

What are the risks associated with them?

1. Artificial Intelligence tools are not secure

AI tools are owned by private companies, in ChatGPT's case that company is OpenAI. ChatGPT is in a 'research preview' of their product which is why it has been made available to the public for free.

OpenAI employees can see anything you put into ChatGPT, and conversations are reviewed by their AI trainers to help improve their systems. This means they are not secure. Therefore, personal and sensitive data should never be passed through them in their current form.

2. Artificial Intelligence tools can get things wrong

Artificial Intelligence tools have been trained using data from books, articles, websites, and other sources, so can only answer prompts using the data it was trained with. In the case of ChatGPT this data only goes up to 2021, so will not be able to provide information about current issues or recent developments.

However, AI bots will attempt to give an answer to a prompt even if it doesn't have the right data, which means it will sometimes give incorrect information or answers that make no sense which are referred to 'hallucinations'. These hallucinations can be very convincing if you are not familiar with a subject area.

Because AI bots are trained by humans with data that was created by humans, they can be biased in the same way that humans are. This is referred to as data bias, an error that occurs when certain elements of a dataset are overweighted or overrepresented, resulting in skewed outcomes, systematic prejudice, and low accuracy.

3. Data Protection Implications

The legal implications of using an AI tool or bot must be carefully considered before it is used to handle personal data (or business confidential data). Please get advice from the Data Protection Advice Team (DPx@xxxxxx.xxx.uk)) before using AI. Automated decision-making, copyright infringement, secondary mining of metadata, and privacy are all data protection considerations that must be justified about the information you pass into AI tools.

Unless you have seen written assurances to the contrary, you should assume any data you input and any output received will be visible to any other users of the system.

If AI tools or bots are being proposed to replace a previous, be added to an existing or create a new business process, then a [Data Privacy Impact Assessment](#) must be completed.

4. The ethics of using Artificial Intelligence tools and bots

Even if AI can shorten or improve a process, there may be ethical considerations about whether we should use AI in those processes.

Despite the huge volumes of data that these AI tools are using to compile their answers, the data bias mentioned above can still perpetuate biases that exist in society and end up gamifying learning.

The ethical justifications for using an AI tool to answer questions or improve a piece of work should be carefully thought out before use.

What should you consider if you're already using or planning to use AI bots?

Digital and Data Services, together with the Data Protection Advice Team, are here to help provide guidance on how we can use these tools in a way that is responsible, ethical and safe.

- One Off Use:

Please follow the guidance provided below if experimenting with AI bots:

1. Be very careful about the information you give to AI bots.

If you are experimenting with AI bots at work, you must be very careful about the prompts you use. Remember that the company that owns the chatbot will have access to any information you put into it. They may use this data to inform the responses their chatbot gives to other people.

Consider if the information you are providing would be appropriate for open public access. If the answer is not a clear yes, you should not be entering the information in a prompt.

2. Never give personal or sensitive information to AI bots.

Never use prompts containing:

- Personal information (yours or anyone else's) such as names, addresses, or any information that could be used to identify someone.
- Organisation-specific sensitive information, such as information related to a restructure.
- Confidential information, such as details about commercial contracts.

3. Always check your work.

You must always check any answers or outputs you get. Don't assume it is correct, and don't use it without reading it first.

If you are unsure, ask an expert or do more research through other methods.

- ***Using AI bots or other AI services within a regular workflow:***

If you are considering using AI bots as part of a business process (ie. Directing your team to run all copy for a particular process through a bot first to check for errors etc.) or are considering using an API that would automatically include bots within a flow of work.

A DPIA must be completed and discussed with the Data Protection Advice Team.

DPA@camden.gov.uk This should be done by the service lead with as much input from your service area and information on the AI involved as possible. Direct link to [Data Protection Impact Assessments \(sharepoint.com\)](#)

What else is the Council doing about AI and bots?

We will continue to be creating policies and guidance about the use of AI tools across the council, and researching the growing tools available to us.

Chatbot tools in development, such as Microsoft Co-Pilot, are not yet public, which could present more opportunities in future. These will likely increase our ability to maintain privacy and security in more ways.

We expect these tools to be in a 'beta' phase this winter and into 2024. The Digital and Data Services Team have asked to be part of these tests when they begin.

Join the ongoing discussion

This technology is powerful and exciting, with enormous potential to improve our citizen's lives. The best way to understand how to use it safely and ethically is by working together and having an ongoing open and transparent dialogue.

We plan to hold discussions, information and workshop sessions soon, and we would like to invite anyone interested to take part. Register your interest via this form. **[insert basic register of interest]**

If you are not sure what to do, reach out to the Technology Adoption Team via the [Yammer - Technology Adoption](#)

Terms relating to AI

- **AI Bots:** Short for artificial intelligence bots, are computer programs or software applications that use artificial intelligence techniques to perform specific tasks or engage in conversation with users. These bots are designed to mimic human-like interactions and can perform automated actions or provide information based on the input they receive.
- **Prompts:** Prompts are the initial instructions, questions, or statements given to the bot to guide its behaviour or generate a response. A prompt serves as a starting point for the bot's understanding and subsequent output. It can be a single sentence or a more complex set of instructions, depending on the capabilities and design of the AI bot.
- **Hallucinations:** Hallucinations refer to the generation of outputs or responses that are imaginative or unrealistic. AI models, including language models like GPT-3, can sometimes generate text that goes beyond the given prompt or the available knowledge, resulting in creative or nonsensical responses. These unexpected and often imaginative outputs are referred to as hallucinations.
- **Bias:** Refers to the presence of unfair or prejudiced behaviour in the responses or actions of the bot. Bias can occur if the underlying training data used to train the AI model contains prejudiced information or reflects societal biases. This bias can be unintentionally learned and perpetuated by the AI bot, leading to discriminatory or skewed responses. It is important to address and mitigate bias to ensure fairness and inclusivity in AI systems.

Note: The explanations provided here are simplified for easy understanding and were generated by Chat GPT. The concepts of AI bots, prompts, hallucinations, and bias can be more nuanced and complex when considering the technical and ethical aspects of AI.

Useful Resources

- The ICO provides a range of useful guidance - [Artificial intelligence | ICO](#)
- Further guidance [Office for Artificial Intelligence - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)

FAQ

Is it okay for me and my team to use generative AI then?

Yes, colleagues can make use of the AI available as long as you and your team follow the guidance on this page. Most importantly do not input in any personal or sensitive information.

What are the most reliable/best AI tools to use?

We have compiled a list of AI tools that have proved useful for various use cases (here is a link to that list). However, there are new AI tools becoming available all the time so join our AI community to find out what else is out there and if you find one then please use our community to share why it might be useful (link to community).

We're finding using AI in the team really useful, we want to add it into a process and make its use a regular part of what we do. What should we do next?

If you want to start making it common practice to use an AI tool within your team or a business process, you should next complete a DPIA to assess the impact. You can complete the DPIA [here](#) and discuss the impact with the Data Team.

I've accidentally uploaded some personal or sensitive data into a bot, what should I do?

You need to complete a data breach form and the team can discuss next steps. You can find the form [here](#).